it up there, letting it run gradually on and off, and standing on the land to the depth of a few inches. This soaks out the salt or rather so much of it as to render the land most productive for wheat, barley, melons cotton etc. I shall in a future letter give my dear Father as good a description as I can of this process, which as there is no want of fresh water in England may be adopted with advantage.

Whilst at Maranghd I procured from the Govr an order to enable us to bank up the river which in times of inundation passes our grounds. This dam had for many years been neglected and the water chiefly carried off by the farmers of another village who had no right to it. We shall have some difficulty but if done it will bring an immense tract of land into cultivation.

[EDWARD BURGESS TO GEORGE BURGESS] *Tabreez, January 10, 1846*

You appear surprised that no English merchants are settled here but will not be so when I tell you how the Greeks came to establish themselves here. You have perhaps heard that the Greeks had for many years an extensive trade chiefly in Manchester goods, at Constantinople. These goods were almost entirely sold to Persians who brought them here for consumption in the country, and exportation. They (the Greeks) had encouraged the Persians by giving them almost unlimited credit, and the consequence was that the latter, overdid the trade to such an extent that many sorts of goods were to be had cheaper retail in Tehran than they could be bought in Manchester. Extensive failures amongst the Persians followed and then some amongst the Greeks, and one or two of the Greek houses who were not ruined sent an agent here to dispose of the goods in Tabreez instead of selling them to the Persians to be so disposed of. Another reason the Greeks had for establishing houses here was that besides failing the Persians cheated them in many ways.

After they were settled here they began having new designs made in Manchester and to do this they have sometimes sent home a Cashmeer shawl the pattern of which suited the Persian taste, or had the design painted by Persian painters to send home. The prints so made are chiefly 5 Col[or] Prints costing about fifteen or sixteen shillings at Manchester and we will say the old patterns sold for about S25/ here. The new designs are printed in the same calicoe have the same colours in them and the same work as the old ones and cost very little more but being new they have sold as high as S40/. I have seen some of these prints made to imitate cashmeer so exactly that until within a few feet you could not tell the difference, and the shawl which they resembled could not cost less than 5 or 6 £ a yard, the print S 1/6/ here. You are wrong in supposing that merchants have little security for person and property in this country. They enjoy now many more priveleges than they did in Turkey and I think are much

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